

The Perfect Sleep Environment

CHECKLIST PLANNER

*Get the room right once.
Then it works every night.*

Setup
One-Time

Bible
Safe Sleep

Log
Nightly

Troubleshoot

Room-by-room setup tracker · Safe Sleep (Bonus 5) · Chapter 5 environment
Darkness · White Noise · Temperature · Crib · Monitor · Room-sharing
Nightly condition log · Tog guide · Science reference · Troubleshooting

Quick Start Tonight

Safe Sleep Checklist

Nightly Log

Six & Thriving

Companion to Sleep, Baby. Please. — Chapter 5 + Bonus 5

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Quick Start — Do This Tonight

TONIGHT

If you do nothing else, do these 8 things before the next sleep.

- 1 ☐ Walk into the nursery right now — can you see anything with lights off?
- 2 ☐ Is the white noise on and audible at crib level?
- 3 ☐ Check the room thermometer — is it in the 68–72°F / 20–22°C range?
- 4 ☐ Cover every LED in the room with electrical tape right now.
- 5 ☐ Check the sleep sack tog rating against the room temperature.
- 6 ☐ Confirm the crib has nothing in it except baby + fitted sheet + sleep sack.
- 7 ☐ Check the monitor is not inside or against the crib.
- 8 ☐ Look at the door gap — is light coming under it from the hallway?

Done is better than perfect.

Fix one thing right now, then work through the full room checklist when it's daylight.

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The Room Setup System

SETUP GUIDE

Work through each section once. Tick everything off. Then rely on the nightly log.

Jump to any setup section

[1. Darkness](#)[2. White Noise](#)[3. Temperature](#)[4. Crib & Surface](#)[5. Monitor](#)[6. Room-Sharing](#)[7. General Env.](#)

Priority Legend

CRITICAL AAP safe sleep guideline or direct safety risk. Must be complete before baby sleeps in this room.

IMPORTANT Significantly impacts sleep quality. Complete within the first week.

RECOMMENDED Evidence-based optimisation. Complete when you can — worth doing.

The Setup Philosophy

The room works for you or against you every single night. Most sleep problems that persist after a good routine is in place are environment problems in disguise — usually light, usually temperature. The one-time setup investment pays back hundreds of times.

You do not need a perfect nursery. You need a dark, temperature-controlled, noise-masked sleep space. That's it. This planner gets you there systematically.

My Setup Progress

Setup Start Date

Baby's Name

Room Type

Target Bedtime

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Darkness — Room Setup

SECTION 1: DARKNESS

The single highest-impact change. True blackout before anything else.

Section status:



Not started



In progress



Complete



N/A for us



True blackout curtains or blinds installed

Not 'room-darkening' — hold a phone torch behind the fabric. Zero light through = pass.

CRITICAL



All monitor/device LEDs covered with electrical tape

Even a single dim indicator light can suppress melatonin. Tape every LED.

CRITICAL



Door gap light sealed (draft stopper or blackout panel)

Hallway light under the door counts. Use a door-bottom draft seal.

IMPORTANT



Nightlight removed OR replaced with red-spectrum only

White/blue nightlights disrupt melatonin. Red-spectrum: acceptable if needed.

IMPORTANT



Window frame light leaks identified and sealed

Use blackout tape or foam strips on frame gaps. Check at midday.

RECOMMENDED

Notes / what I ordered / still to do

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White Noise — Room Setup

SECTION 2 · WHITE NOISE

Mask household sounds. Recreate the familiar womb environment.

Section status:



Not started



In progress



Complete



N/A for us



White noise machine purchased and positioned

Place 3–6 feet from crib, never inside or right against it.

CRITICAL



Volume calibrated to 60–65 dB at crib head level

Use a free dB meter app. Similar to shower noise. Not a whisper, not a jet engine.

CRITICAL



Sound type selected and set to run all night

White/brown/pink noise or rain. Consistent is better than varied.

IMPORTANT



Extension cord / power supply confirmed stable

Machine must not cut out mid-night. Test for 48 hours before relying on it.

RECOMMENDED



Machine not placed inside the crib or against the crib rail

Distance protects hearing. A few feet away is ideal.

CRITICAL

Notes / what I ordered / still to do

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Temperature — Room Setup

SECTION 3: TEMPERATURE

68–72°F / 20–22°C at crib height. Measured, not assumed.

Section status:



Not started



In progress



Complete



N/A for us



Room thermometer installed at crib level

Not a wall thermostat — measure where baby actually sleeps.

CRITICAL



Room confirmed 68–72°F / 20–22°C at crib height

Too warm = more rousing. Too cold = disrupted sleep. Goldilocks zone is critical.

CRITICAL



Central heating/cooling set to maintain target overnight

Set it and test for 2 nights. Note if it overshoots in early morning.

IMPORTANT



Sleep sack tog rating matched to room temperature

0.5 tog: 24°C+. 1.0 tog: 20–23°C. 2.5 tog: 16–20°C. 3.5 tog: below 16°C.

IMPORTANT



Baby's chest warm but not sweaty — test regularly

Check the chest/back of neck, not hands or feet (always cooler on babies).

IMPORTANT



No direct heating/cooling vent blowing on crib

Drafts and direct airflow disrupt sleep and create uneven temperature.

RECOMMENDED

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Crib & Sleep Surface — Setup

SECTION 4 • CRIB & SURFACE

The sleep surface is the foundation. Every item here is non-negotiable.

Section status:



Not started



In progress



Complete



N/A



Firm, flat mattress — no incline, wedge, or pillow-top

AAP guideline. A firm surface that does not indent under baby's weight.

CRITICAL



Fitted sheet only on mattress — nothing else

No loose blankets, bumpers, pillows, positioners, or stuffed animals.

CRITICAL



Mattress fits snugly — no gaps between mattress and crib sides

Gaps larger than 2 fingers are a safety concern. Replace mattress if needed.

CRITICAL



Baby placed on back — every sleep, every time, without exception

Back-sleeping until baby can roll both ways independently.

CRITICAL



Sleep sack used instead of blanket

Choose size and tog for current weight and room temperature.

CRITICAL



No stuffed animals, positioners, or wedges in sleep space

Safe from birth. Comfort object (lovey) appropriate from 12 months.

CRITICAL



Crib slat spacing confirmed safe (under 2.375 inches / 6 cm)

Older cribs may not meet current standards. Verify if using second-hand crib.

IMPORTANT



Crib positioned away from windows, cords, and curtains

Strangulation and temperature risk. Minimum 3 feet from all window coverings.

IMPORTANT

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Crib & Sleep Surface — Continued

SECTION 4: CONTINUED

Finishing the 10-point crib safety checklist.



All window blind/curtain cords looped up and out of reach

Cord strangulation is a leading cause of accidental death. Cordless blinds preferred.

CRITICAL



Crib hardware checked and all bolts confirmed tight

Check monthly. Rattling hardware can startle baby during light sleep.

RECOMMENDED

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Monitor — Room Setup

SECTION 5 • MONITOR

Positioned correctly, dimmed, tested. Not inside the crib.

Section status:



Not started



In progress



Complete



N/A for us



Baby monitor positioned correctly — not inside crib

Monitor should view the whole crib. Minimum 3 feet from baby.

CRITICAL



Monitor screen brightness set to lowest possible

If monitor screen is in your bedroom, face it away or cover when not checking.

IMPORTANT



Monitor alert volume tested — audible from parent bedroom

Test at actual distance with door closed. Ensure it can wake a sleeping adult.

IMPORTANT



WiFi/Bluetooth monitor security reviewed

Change default passwords. Enable two-factor if available.

RECOMMENDED

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Room-Sharing — Setup

SECTION 6 • ROOM-SHARING

AAP recommends room-sharing for 6–12 months. Here's how to do it right.

Section status:



Not started



In progress



Complete



N/A for us



Visual partition between baby sleep space and parent area

A curtain, room divider, or crib placement that creates visual separation.

IMPORTANT



Parent phone and device screens dimmed for night feeds

Keep phone brightness to minimum. No scrolling bright screens during feeds.

IMPORTANT



Bedside lamp on red-spectrum or dimmest warm setting

Or use a small red-spectrum clip light for feeding only.

IMPORTANT



Bedsharing NOT occurring as default — crib/bassinet used

AAP: room-sharing yes, bed-sharing no. If bedsharing intentionally, follow safe bedsharing guidelines.

CRITICAL

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General Environment — Setup

SECTION 7 • GENERAL

The finishing details that prevent surprise disruptions.

Section status:



Not started



In progress



Complete



N/A for us



Nursery door hardware confirmed silent (no squeaking)

Oil hinges. Replace squeaking hardware. A noisy exit wakes babies.

RECOMMENDED



Rocking chair / glider stable and not squeaking

Test before use. Squeaks during feeds can create light-sleep arousal.

RECOMMENDED



Phone on silent (not vibrate) during baby's sleep hours

Vibrate on a hard surface is audible. Full silent during naps and bedtime.

RECOMMENDED



Household noise pattern understood and managed

Sibling play, TV, kitchen — white noise masks most. Plan for peak noise periods.

RECOMMENDED



Nightlight location confirmed (or confirmed absent)

If using, place near door not near crib. Red spectrum only.

IMPORTANT

Notes / what I ordered / still to do

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Safe Sleep Checklist — Bonus 5

SAFE SLEEP • BONUS 5

AAP-aligned guidelines. Run through this every night until it is muscle memory.

THE SLEEP SURFACE

- ☐ Firm, flat mattress — no incline, pillow-top, or wedge
- ☐ Fitted sheet only — no loose blankets, bumpers, or pillows
- ☐ No stuffed animals, positioners, or sleep aids inside the crib
- ☐ Sleep sack used in place of a blanket — tog matched to room temperature
- ☐ Baby placed on their back — every sleep, every time, without exception
- ☐ Crib, bassinet, or play yard only — not a swing, car seat, or bouncer

THE ROOM

- ☐ Room temperature confirmed between 68–72°F / 20–22°C
- ☐ Baby's chest feels warm but not sweaty — adjust tog if needed
- ☐ True blackout achieved — if you can see your hand, it is too bright
- ☐ White noise running at a continuous low level — not inside the crib
- ☐ Monitor screen and indicator LEDs covered with electrical tape
- ☐ No nightlight in use, or red-spectrum light only

Room-Sharing Note (AAP)

Room-sharing — not bed-sharing — for the first 6–12 months reduces SIDS risk by up to 50%. Baby sleeps in their own safe surface within arm's reach. Chapter 5 covers full setup.

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Tog Rating Quick Guide

TOG REFERENCE

Match the sleep sack to the room temperature. Print and post in the nursery.

Room Temperature

Tog Rating

Dressing Guide

Below 16°C / 61°F

3.5 tog

Long-sleeve bodysuit + 3.5 tog sleep sack

16–20°C / 61–68°F

2.5 tog

Long-sleeve bodysuit + 2.5 tog sleep sack

20–23°C / 68–73°F

1.0 tog

Short-sleeve bodysuit + 1.0 tog sleep sack

24°C+ / 75°F+

0.5 tog

Nappy/short-sleeve only + 0.5 tog sleep sack

My Nursery Settings

Normal room temp (°C/°F)

Sleep sack we use

Tog rating we use

Dressing underneath

Notes / brand / size

The Rule of Thumb

Dress your baby in one more layer than you would wear comfortably in the same room. A chest that is warm (not hot) and a back of the neck that is slightly warm (not sweaty) means the tog is right. Hands and feet are always cooler — don't judge by them.

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Sleep Environment Science — Why It Matters

SCIENCE REFERENCE

The evidence behind each room setup decision.

Darkness & Melatonin

Melatonin production begins when the retina detects darkness. Even 10 lux — a dim nightlight — can suppress melatonin by up to 50% in infants. True blackout means zero detectable light. If you can see your hand, it is too bright.

White Noise Science

The womb measures 80–85 dB — similar to a vacuum cleaner. A silent nursery is jarring to a newborn's nervous system. White noise at 60–65 dB masks startling household sounds and recreates the familiar womb environment. Never exceed 65 dB at crib level.

Temperature & Sleep Architecture

Core body temperature must drop 1–2°F to initiate sleep. Rooms above 72°F / 22°C prevent this drop and cause more frequent arousal. Too cold (below 65°F / 18°C) causes the same effect. 68–72°F is the evidence-based sweet spot.

Tog Ratings Explained

Tog measures thermal insulation. 0.5 tog: 24°C+ rooms. 1.0 tog: 20–23°C. 2.5 tog: 16–20°C. 3.5 tog: below 16°C. Overdressing is a greater risk than underdressing. When in doubt, go lower tog and layer underneath.

The LED Problem

Monitor screens, power indicator LEDs, smoke detector lights, charging cables — all emit light. Research shows blue/white light exposure at night shifts the circadian clock and disrupts infant sleep. Cover every LED with electrical tape before the first night.

Room-Sharing vs Bed-Sharing

The AAP recommends room-sharing for 6–12 months — it reduces SIDS risk by up to 50%. Bed-sharing is a separate and higher-risk practice. Room-sharing means the baby sleeps in their own safe sleep surface within arm's reach, not in the parent's bed.

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Environment Troubleshooting

TROUBLESHOOT

Persistent sleep problems after setup? Start here.

Baby wakes 45 min into every nap

Classic sleep cycle transition. Ensure darkness and white noise are optimal for naps too. Check if any light enters at midday (sun angle changes). Be in the room at the 40-min mark to attempt resettling before full waking.

Baby wakes with every household sound

White noise volume may be too low, or machine may be too far from crib. Increase volume slightly (max 65 dB at crib head). Ensure it runs continuously — some machines auto-off after 30–60 min.

Baby is sweaty but room is within target temperature

Sleep sack tog is too high. Drop one tog level. Check if central heating is spiking in early morning. A chest that is warm but not sweaty is the target.

Baby seems cold despite appropriate tog

Add a short-sleeve onesie under the sleep sack before increasing tog. Check for drafts from vents, windows, or fans blowing directly on crib.

Early morning waking (4–5am)

Most common cause: light entering room at sunrise. Check east-facing windows especially. Add blackout tape to any frame gaps. A second layer of blackout curtain often solves this.

Baby startles awake when parent enters or exits

Door hinges need oiling. Practice the exit sequence in daylight. Ensure white noise is running before entry. Move slowly and without sudden movements.

Room temperature varies significantly overnight

Thermostat may be on a schedule. Set to 'hold' at 20°C/68°F overnight. Consider a secondary programmable plug-in heater/cooler for the nursery only.

Nightly Condition Log — Week 1

NIGHTLY LOG

Log these 6 conditions each night. Patterns emerge by night 3.

Night	Date	Temp °F/°C	Blackout?	W.Noise?	Tog	Crib OK?	LEDs?	Notes
1			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
2			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
3			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
4			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
5			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
6			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
7			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	

Week 1 Summary

Most common issue this week

Average room temp

Tog used most nights

What I adjusted this week

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Nightly Condition Log — Week 2

NIGHTLY LOG

Log these 6 conditions each night. Patterns emerge by night 3.

Night	Date	Temp °F/°C	Blackout?	W.Noise?	Tog	Crib OK?	LEDs?	Notes
8			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
9			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
10			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
11			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
12			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
13			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
14			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	

Week 2 Summary

Most common issue this week

Average room temp

Tog used most nights

What I adjusted this week

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Nightly Condition Log — Week 3

NIGHTLY LOG

Log these 6 conditions each night. Patterns emerge by night 3.

Night	Date	Temp °F/°C	Blackout?	W.Noise?	Tog	Crib OK?	LEDs?	Notes
15			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
16			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
17			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
18			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
19			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
20			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
21			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	

Week 3 Summary

Most common issue this week

Average room temp

Tog used most nights

What I adjusted this week

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Nightly Condition Log — Week 4

NIGHTLY LOG

Log these 6 conditions each night. Patterns emerge by night 3.

Night	Date	Temp °F/°C	Blackout?	W.Noise?	Tog	Crib OK?	LEDs?	Notes
22			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
23			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
24			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
25			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
26			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
27			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
28			☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	

Week 4 Summary

Most common issue this week

Average room temp

Tog used most nights

What I adjusted this week

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My Room Settings — Permanent Record

ROOM RECORD

Fill this in once the room is dialled in. Post on the nursery wall or inside the door.

Final Confirmed Settings

DARKNESS

Blackout curtain brand/model

LED tape used?

WHITE NOISE

Machine brand/model

Volume (dB)

Sound type

TEMPERATURE

Target temp (°C/°F)

Thermostat setting

Confirmed OK?

SLEEP SACK

Brand/model

Current tog

Size

Dressing under

MONITOR

Monitor brand/model

Position from crib

Brightness

NIGHTLIGHT

Type (red/none/other)

Position in room

Additional Setup Notes

Print & Post — Nightly 30-Second Check:

✓ Temp in range ✓ Blackout confirmed ✓ White noise ON ✓ Tog correct ✓ Crib clear ✓ LEDs covered

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